



FINC 612 Course Syllabus

Course Information

Course Number:	FINC 612
Course Title:	Finance for the Professional
Section:	701
Time:	Tuesdays 6:00pm – 7:30pm CST
Location:	In addition to weekly synchronous class lectures, asynchronous lectures will be assigned each week. See Electronic Course Support section below.
Credit Hours:	3

Instructor Details

Instructor:	Boone Bowles
Office:	Wehner 360Q
E-Mail:	boone.bowles@tamu.edu
Office Hours:	Office hours will be every Wednesday from 8:00 - 9:30 p.m. CT. If no students join by 8:15, the session will end. Students may always reach out to the instructor via email with questions or to schedule individual meetings.

Course Description

Focuses on investment and financing decisions in corporate firms; emphasis on principles, techniques and applications in corporate finance including risk and return, capital budgeting, discounted cash flow valuation, capital structure, and payout policy.

FINC 612: Finance for the Professional equips students with a broad understanding of finance and with the specific skill of valuation, also known as capital budgeting. More simply, FINC 612 teaches students how to think like a CFO of a business.

As a core course in the Flex Online MBA program, FINC 612 prepares all students to make important financial decisions within a business or to at least understand how financial decisions are made. For students specializing in finance, this course is a first step to securing a job in a CFO's office or a finance-related job in another area. Even for entrepreneurial students, this course is essential to help them make value-enhancing decisions.

Course Prerequisites

Graduate classification.



Course Learning Outcomes

By the end of this course, you will be able to:

- Produce a business proposal by analyzing future business projects and deciding whether to invest.
- Calculate the weighted average cost of capital for a specific business by producing a three-page report detailing interest rates and company risks.
- Formulate strategic recommendations for financial decision-making by evaluating complex scenarios, synthesizing data from multiple sources, and conducting sensitivity analysis.

Textbook and/or Resource Materials

Berk, & DeMarzo. (2023). *Corporate Finance, 6th edition*. Pearson. ISBN: 978-0-13-784502-6
Microsoft Excel

Grading Policy

Grades will be assigned based on the following learning activity categories.

Assignment Groups and Weights

Learning Activity	Total Points	Total Weights
Perusall Assignments	20	5%
Quizzes	70	20%
Minor Individual Assignments	70	5%
Minor group assignments	20	25%
Major group assignments	30	35%
Getting Started	20	10%
Interactive Lessons	0	0%
TOTAL	230	100%

Grade Distribution

A – 90-100%

B – 80-89.5%

C – 70-79.5%

D – 60-69.5%

F – 59.5% or lower

Retake: 59.5% or lower



Learning Activities

The goal of this course is to provide you with relevant knowledge, skills, and experiences that will help you achieve the learning objectives of this course. You are encouraged to fully participate in this course for an impactful learning experience. There are different due dates for most of the assignments. It is your responsibility to meet these deadlines.

Each week will begin on a Monday and end on a Sunday. However, new material opens on Saturday at 12:00am CT one week before the module starts. All assignments (unless otherwise stated) will be due Sundays at 11:59pm.

There are a variety of learning activities in the course, including:

Perusall Assignments – Two assignments use Perusall to foster critical thinking and collaborative discussion about key perspectives on the purpose of a firm. Through reading, commenting, and engaging with peers, you'll critically reflect on the ethical and strategic considerations businesses face.

Quizzes – Each quiz in this course provides an opportunity to practice the formulas and calculations introduced in the modules. These quizzes are designed to reinforce your understanding of key concepts and help you build the technical skills needed for success in financial analysis.

Minor Individual Assignment – These assignments focus on applying key concepts like time value of money, bond pricing, break-even, and sensitivity analysis. Through practice problems and scenario-based questions, you'll strengthen your ability to perform financial calculations and analyses essential for decision-making in real-world business contexts.

Minor Group Assignment – These group assignments are designed to build foundational skills and introduce the types of tasks featured in the major group assignments. Through collaboration, you'll practice crafting professional deliverables such as corporate statements, financial analyses, and strategic reports. These activities help you refine analytical, problem-solving, and communication skills essential for financial decision-making and teamwork.

Major Group Assignment – The major group assignments challenge you to apply advanced financial concepts to complex, real-world scenarios. These projects build on the skills developed in the minor assignments and require deep collaboration and critical thinking. You will evaluate significant financial decisions, perform detailed analyses, and present professional reports with clear recommendations. These assignments are comprehensive, designed to separate those who have mastered the material from those who have not.



Interactive Lesson – Each module includes my assigned readings, designed to supplement the main material with essential context and background. These concise readings are crucial for getting the most out of the week’s Cohort Session and assignments. While ungraded, they are a required component of the course and must be completed on time to ensure you are fully prepared for each week’s tasks. Full engagement with these readings is expected, just as with any other required course content.

Cohort Sessions

Cohort sessions are our live virtual meetings, held weekly unless otherwise specified in the course schedule. Each session will take place via Zoom and will last for 90 minutes. These meetings are designed to give you the opportunity to interact directly with the course instructors and teaching assistants, receive live feedback, and engage in cohort session learning activities.

Session Time

Day of the Week: Tuesday
Meeting Time: 6:00pm to 7:30pm, Central
First Meeting: Tuesday January 14, 2025

Session Zoom Links

You will find links to the Zoom meetings for the cohort sessions by selecting “Zoom Pro 1.3” from the course navigation menu in Canvas. You may choose to use the shortcut “Cohort Sessions” tile from the course homepage in Canvas.

Late Work Policy

Assignments submitted after the deadline will incur an automatic 25% deduction if submitted within the first 24 hours past the due date. Assignments submitted between 24 and 48 hours late will incur an additional 25% deduction (50% total). After 48 hours, the assignment will be locked, and late submissions will no longer be accepted. Exceptions will only be made in documented, extraordinary circumstances.

Work submitted by a student as makeup work for an excused absence is not considered late work and is exempted from the late work policy ([Student Rule 7](#)).

Course Schedule

The table below provides an overview of the learning modules and their associated topics, learning materials, and learning activities. Each learning module is identified by number and a week. The Date column shows the start date for each module, but it does not show the due date for the learning materials and learning activities. You can locate the due dates for the learning materials and learning activities in the Canvas course modules.



Week	Start Date	Module Name and Topics	Learning Materials and Activities
1	01/06	Module 1 - The Firm: What is it and what does it do? - The types of firms (sole proprietorship, partnership, limited liability company, corporations). - The Agency Problem: the wedge between the owners' incentives and the manager's incentives. - The purpose of a firm: shareholder value maximization and profits or stakeholders?	Read: - Textbook: Berk, & DeMarzo. (2023). <i>Corporate Finance, 6th edition</i>. Pearson. ISBN: 978-0-13-784502-6 - Chapter 1, pp 1-21 - Article: Kessler. (2021). <i>How to Answer the 'Trap Question'</i>. The Wall Street Journal. Watch: - Boone Bowles. (2024). <i>Firm Control and Agency Costs</i>. (4:49) - Boone Bowles. (2024). <i>Purpose of a Firm</i>. (2:49) Complete: - Discussion Class Introductions - Quiz Syllabus Acknowledgement - Interactive Lesson The Firm: What is it and What Does it Do? - Perusall Assignment The Friedman Doctrine - Perusall Assignment Business Roundtable - Module 1 Quiz - Minor Group Assignment The Purpose of a Business
2	01/13	Module 2 - Financial Statements: How do we analyze the health of a business? - The sources of financial information (SEC's EDGAR system, Yahoo! Finance, CNBC, and investor relations webpages). - Income statements and balance sheets. - Financial ratio analysis. - Free Cash Flow.	Read: - Textbook: Berk, & DeMarzo. (2023). <i>Corporate Finance, 6th edition</i>. Pearson. ISBN: 978-0-13-784502-6 - Chapter 2, pp 27-55 - Chapter 8, parts 8.1 and 8.2, pp 243-256 Watch: - Boone Bowles. (2024). <i>Lowes and Home Depot</i>. (5:54) - Boone Bowles. (2024). <i>Free Cash Flow</i>. (4:26) - Boone Bowles. (2024). <i>Lowes & Home Depot - Free Cash Flow</i>. (3:41)



Week	Start Date	Module Name and Topics	Learning Materials and Activities
			Complete: - Interactive Lesson How do We Analyze the Health of a Business? - Module 2 Quiz - Minor Group Assignment Financial Ratios Calculations
3	01/20	Module 3 - The Time Value of Money: How to do financial time travel? - Time value of money calculations. - Bond pricing.	Read: - Textbook: Berk, & DeMarzo. (2023). <i>Corporate Finance, 6th edition</i>. Pearson. ISBN: 978-0-13-784502-6 - Chapter 4, pp 104-137 - Chapter 6, pp 177-201 Watch: - Boone Bowles. (2024). <i>Time Value of Money</i>. (3:29) - Boone Bowles. (2024). <i>Crazy Cash Flow 1</i>. (3:54) - Boone Bowles. (2024). <i>Crazy Cash Flow 2</i>. (2:28) - Boone Bowles. (2024). <i>Perpetuity</i>. (2:49) - Boone Bowles. (2024). <i>Crazy Cash Flow 3</i>. (3:12) Complete: - Interactive Lesson The Time Value of Money: How to do Financial Time Travel? - Module 3 Quiz - Minor Individual Assignment TVM and Bond Pricing
4	01/27	Module 4 - Capital Budgeting: How do firms value projects and make decisions? - Free Cash Flow (FCF) and projections. - Time value of money. - Present value of cash flows.	Read: - Textbook: Berk, & DeMarzo. (2023). <i>Corporate Finance, 6th edition</i>. Pearson. ISBN: 978-0-13-784502-6 - Chapter 3, pp 67-87 - Chapter 7, pp 216-234 - Chapter 8, parts 8.1-8.4, pp 243-261 Watch:



Week	Start Date	Module Name and Topics	Learning Materials and Activities
		- Net Present Value (NPV) decision rule. - NPV analysis.	- Boone Bowles. (2024). <i>Web Hosting Business</i>. (5:25) - Boone Bowles. (2024). <i>Timing and Separation</i>. (3:50) - Boone Bowles. (2024). <i>Projects Maroon and Graphite</i>. (6:22) - Boone Bowles. (2024). <i>Homenet</i>. (9:01) Complete: - Interactive Lesson Capital Budgeting: How Do Firms Value Projects and Make Decisions? - Module 4 Quiz - Major Group Assignment NPV and Free Cash Flow Analysis
5	02/03	Module 5 - More Capital Budgeting: How else can we use this new tool? - Sensitivity analysis. - Scenario analysis. - Enterprise value and business valuation.	Read: - Textbook: Berk, & DeMarzo. (2023). <i>Corporate Finance, 6th edition</i>. Pearson. ISBN: 978-0-13-784502-6 - Chapter 8 section 8.5, pp 263-268 - Chapter 9, pp 281-313 Watch: - Boone Bowles. (2024). <i>Homenet Redux</i>. (8:05) - Boone Bowles. (2024). <i>EV 1</i>. (3:16) Complete: - Interactive Lesson More Capital Budgeting: How Else Can We Use This New Tool? - Module 5 Quiz - Minor Individual Assignment Break Even and Sensitivity Analysis
6	02/10	Module 6 - Interest Rates: What underlies the discount rate firms use? Equilibrium interest rates determined by the supply and demand of bonds.	Read: - Textbook: Mishkin, & Eakins. (2021). <i>Financial Markets and Institutions, 9th edition</i>. Pearson. ISBN: 978-0-13-755450-8 - Chapter 4, pp 65-85 - Chapter 6, pp 88-112



Week	Start Date	Module Name and Topics	Learning Materials and Activities
		• The risk structure of interest rates. • The term structure of interest rates.	Watch: • Boone Bowles. (2024). <i>Term Structure</i>. (4:31) • Boone Bowles. (2024). <i>ET, MST, and LPT</i>. (4:33) • Boone Bowles. (2024). <i>YC Interpretations</i>. (2:34) Complete: • Interactive Lesson The Firm: What is it and What Does it Do? • Module 6 Quiz
7	02/17	Module 7 - The Cost of Capital: How do firms calculate their discount rate? • Interest rates as the cost of capital. • Debt and equity. • The Weighted Average Cost of Capital (WACC).	Read: • Textbook: Berk, & DeMarzo. (2023). <i>Corporate Finance, 6th edition</i>. Pearson. ISBN: 978-0-13-784502-6 ○ Chapter 10, pp 324-354 ○ Chapter 12, pp 413-437 ○ (Optional) ▪ Chapter 11 pp 363-398 Watch: • Boone Bowles. (2024). <i>Beta and the Cost of Equity Capital</i>. (4:17) • Boone Bowles. (2024). <i>The Cost of Debt and WACC</i>. (4:12) Complete: • Interactive Lesson The Cost of Capital: How Do Firms Calculate Their Discount Rate? • Module 7 Quiz • Minor Group Assignment Estimating Alpha Trucking's Cost of Capital – Introduction • Minor Group Assignment Estimating Alpha Trucking's Cost of Capital • Minor Group Assignment Estimating Alpha Trucking's Cost of Capital



Week	Start Date	Module Name and Topics	Learning Materials and Activities
8	02/24	Module 8 - Putting it all Together: Am I a financial professional now? All topics in Modules 4, 5, and 6.	Read: - none Watch: - none Complete: - Major Group Assignment Valuing Alpha Trucking for Strategic Decisions

Additional Course Information

Technology Support

This course relies heavily on the Canvas learning management system and other learning tools such as Articulate Rise. You MUST have access to strong, reliable internet connections. You are expected to consider this requirement when starting an online assignment or assessment. "Poor internet connection" does not constitute an excuse for late work or missed assignments. If you experience internet difficulty, you are to report the issue to the instructor immediately.

Cohort sessions will take place via Zoom. The same Zoom link will be used for all class sessions and will be made available to you via Canvas. You should log in with your authorized TAMU Zoom account. You are encouraged to familiarize yourself with Zoom functions before class and ensure you have a working microphone and speakers (or headphones, if preferred). You may stay muted to avoid distracting background noise or audio feedback/echo. You are highly encouraged but not required to turn on your camera during cohort sessions. You can use the [Flex Online Zoom background generator](#) to create a Zoom background for this course. You may ask questions or make comments during the cohort session using the chat function, the "raise hand" function, or by unmuting and asking questions aloud.

University Policies

This section outlines the university level policies. The TAMU Faculty Senate established the wording of these policies. Policies relating to Mays Flex Online programs/courses can be found under the corresponding section at the end of the document.

Attendance Policy

The university views class attendance and participation as an individual student responsibility. Students are expected to attend class and to complete all assignments.

Please refer to [Student Rule 7](#) in its entirety for information about excused absences, including definitions, and related documentation and timelines.



NOTE: Please see the *Flex Online attendance policy* below for additional information.

Makeup Work Policy

Students will be excused from attending class on the day of a graded activity or when attendance contributes to a student's grade, for the reasons stated in Student Rule 7, or other reason deemed appropriate by the instructor. Please refer to [Student Rule 7](#) in its entirety for information about makeup work, including definitions, and related documentation and timelines. Absences related to Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972 may necessitate a period of more than 30 days for make-up work, and the timeframe for make-up work should be agreed upon by the student and instructor" ([Student Rule 7, Section 7.4.1](#)). "The instructor is under no obligation to provide an opportunity for the student to make up work missed because of an unexcused absence" ([Student Rule 7, Section 7.4.2](#)). Students who request an excused absence are expected to uphold the Aggie Honor Code and Student Conduct Code. (See [Student Rule 24](#).)

Academic Integrity Statement and Policy

"An Aggie does not lie, cheat or steal, or tolerate those who do."

"Texas A&M University students are responsible for authenticating all work submitted to an instructor. If asked, students must be able to produce proof that the item submitted is indeed the work of that student. Students must keep appropriate records at all times. The inability to authenticate one's work, should the instructor request it, may be sufficient grounds to initiate an academic misconduct case" ([Section 20.1.2.3, Student Rule 20](#)). You can learn more about the Aggie Honor System Office Rules and Procedures, academic integrity, and your rights and responsibilities at aggiehonor.tamu.edu.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) Policy

Texas A&M University is committed to providing equitable access to learning opportunities for all students. If you experience barriers to your education due to a disability or think you may have a disability, please contact the Disability Resources office on your campus (resources listed below). Disabilities may include, but are not limited to attentional, learning, mental health, sensory, physical, or chronic health conditions. All students are encouraged to discuss their disability related needs with Disability Resources and their instructors as soon as possible.

Disability Resources is located in the Student Services Building or at (979) 845-1637 or visit disability.tamu.edu.

Title IX and Statement on Limits to Confidentiality

Texas A&M University is committed to fostering a learning environment that is safe and productive for all. University policies and federal and state laws prohibit gender-based discrimination and sexual harassment, including sexual assault, sexual exploitation, domestic violence, dating violence, and stalking.



With the exception of some medical and mental health providers, all university employees (including full and part-time faculty, staff, paid graduate assistants, student workers, etc.) are Mandatory Reporters and must report to the Title IX Office if the employee experiences, observes, or becomes aware of an incident that meets the following conditions (see [University Rule 08.01.01.M1](#)):

- The incident is reasonably believed to be discrimination or harassment.
- The incident is alleged to have been committed by or against a person who, at the time of the incident, was (1) a student enrolled at the University or (2) an employee of the University.

Mandatory Reporters must file a report regardless of how the information comes to their attention – including but not limited to face-to-face conversations, a written class assignment or paper, class discussion, email, text, or social media post. Although Mandatory Reporters must file a report, in most instances, a person who is subjected to the alleged conduct will be able to control how the report is handled, including whether or not to pursue a formal investigation. The University's goal is to make sure you are aware of the range of options available to you and to ensure access to the resources you need.

Students wishing to discuss concerns related to mental and/or physical health in a confidential setting are encouraged to make an appointment with [University Health Services](#) or download the [TELUS Health Student Support app](#) for 24/7 access to professional counseling in multiple languages. Walk-in services for urgent, non-emergency needs are available during normal business hours at University Health Services locations; call 979.458.4584 for details.

Students can learn more about filing a report, accessing supportive resources, and navigating the Title IX investigation and resolution process on the University's [Title IX webpage](#).

Statement on Mental Health and Wellness

Texas A&M University recognizes that mental health and wellness are critical factors influencing a student's academic success and overall wellbeing. Students are encouraged to engage in healthy self-care practices by utilizing the resources and services available through [University Health Services](#). Students needing a listening ear can call the Texas A&M Helpline (979.845.2700) from 4:00 p.m. to 8:00 a.m. weekdays and 24 hours on weekends for mental health peer support while classes are in session. The [TELUS Health Student Support app](#) provides access to professional counseling in multiple languages anytime, anywhere by phone or chat, and the 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline offers 24-hour emergency support at 988 or [988lifeline.org](#).

Students needing a listening ear can contact University Health Services (979.458.4584) or call the Texas A&M Helpline (979.845.2700) from 4:00 p.m. to 8:00 a.m. weekdays and 24 hours on weekends while classes are in session. 24-hour emergency help is also available through the 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline (988) or at [988lifeline.org](#).



Mays Flex Online Policies

The following policies are applicable to Mays Flex Online students and courses. For any questions, please contact your faculty member.

Attendance

Mays Business School views attendance in a Flex Online course as active and timely engagement in all course activities. Failure to engage consistently may impact your overall performance and grade in the course. This includes:

- **Discussion Forums:** Regular and meaningful participation in discussion forums is required. Students should contribute to discussions on a weekly basis, responding to prompts and engaging with peers' posts to foster a collaborative learning environment.
- **Assignments:** All assignments must be completed and submitted by the specified deadlines. Timely submission is essential for keeping up with the course material and ensuring fair assessment.
- **Cohort Sessions:** While attendance at weekly cohort sessions, held via Zoom, is highly recommended, there may be times when attendance is not possible due to work commitments, family obligations, or time zone differences. Sessions will be recorded and made available for later viewing. Students are expected to watch the recordings and stay current with the material covered.

Statement on Outside Resources

Students' work on all graded items should be completed independently and/or as a group, where designated. Using work completed by someone else is considered academic dishonesty. Meaning, you may not use another person's work, unless where appropriate when completing a group assignment, to satisfy your course assignments. This includes, but is not limited to, another person's work obtained through face-to-face conversations, phone calls, text messages, instant messages, chats, Slack exchanges, email messages, social media posts, tutoring sites, questions/answers on discussion forums, blogs, etc.